

YOUR RIDE, YOUR HEALTH

Ronde van Elmet

One bike ride, two workouts in one — a cardio session and a strength session, back to back. Good for every rider, whatever your age.

49.9_{km}

DISTANCE

2h 14_m

TIME OUT

499_m

CLIMBING

155

AVG HEART RATE

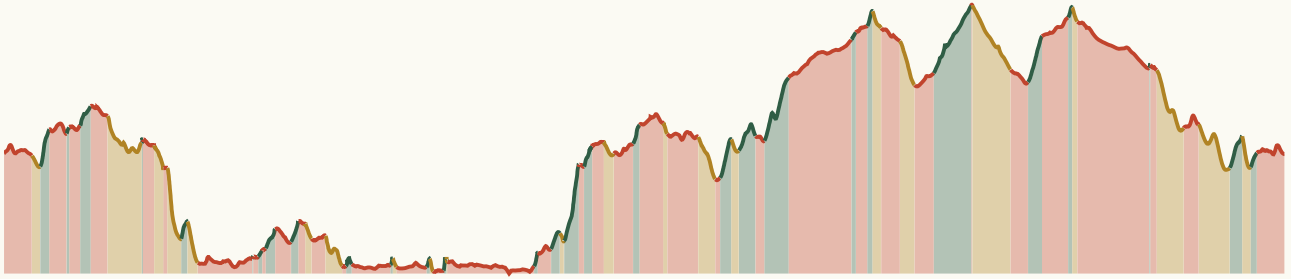
Where the workout changed

Every metre of this ride was tracked by GPS and heart-rate monitor. Here's where you were building your heart, and where you were building your muscles — two named spots stand out.



- Cardio — flat & rolling
- Strength — climbing
- Recovery — coasting down

The same route, laid out flat (height above sea level)



TWO WORKOUTS, ONE RIDE

What each part actually did for you

**BEST SPOT: NCN 67, RIVER
AIRE, STOURTON**



Cardio — the steady heart workout

On the flat sections — like the riverside towpath along the Aire near Stourton — you settled into a strong, steady rhythm you could hold for a long time. This is what trains your heart and lungs to work more efficiently, so everyday activities feel easier.

29 km

FLAT, ALL ROUTE

74 min

TIME SPENT

24 km/h

STEADY PACE

155 bpm

AVG HEART RATE

**BEST SPOT: EAST LEEDS
LINK RD & TEMPLE NEWSAM**



Strength — the muscle workout

Going uphill — like the climb off the East Leeds Link Road past Temple Newsam — your pedal stroke slowed but got much harder, pushing your body weight against gravity over and over. That's real resistance training for your legs, hips and core, no gym required.

9.4 km

OF CLIMBING

35 min

TIME SPENT

499 m

TOTAL HEIGHT GAINED

176 bpm

PEAK EFFORT

Two workouts beat one — for every rider

Steady flat riding builds a strong heart. Climbing builds strong muscles and bones. Riders of any age benefit from both — but the strength side becomes especially important after 50, when the body naturally starts losing muscle and bone density faster.



Keeps muscle you'd otherwise lose

Pushing hard on a climb is resistance training. It tells your legs to hold on to strength instead of quietly losing it year after year — muscle loss that speeds up noticeably from your 50s on.



Loads your bones, for stronger bones

Grinding up a hill puts real force through your hips and legs — the kind of load that helps keep bones dense as you age.



Better balance, fewer falls

The strength and control built climbing carries straight into everyday stability — getting up, carrying things, steady footing.



A metabolism that stays active

Muscle burns energy even at rest. Keeping it means your body stays more efficient, not less, as the years go on.

THE TAKEAWAY

You didn't just go for a bike ride — you did a full workout

The flats trained your heart. The hills trained your muscles and bones. Remember the pattern: **NCN 67 by the River Aire** for a cardio spin, **East Leeds Link Road up to Temple Newsam** when you want the strength session. Great for any rider, any age.